

Govt to unveil guidelines on security-sensitive electronics

The Government of India is soon going to announce guidelines to screen imported electronics, IT and telecom gear deemed "security sensitive" with an aim to secure the country's core information infrastructure, according to sources.

The home ministry has reportedly identified eight categories of electronics, namely cameras, radars, routers, base stations, devices used for data storage/transmission, general computers and biometric/access control devices. The products coming under these categories will go through a stringent security drill if imported from abroad, according to internal ministerial documents.

The Economic Times report said, "The home ministry has already evolved a template to assess whether a specific electronic item poses a security risk. For instance, electronics than can be connected to the Internet, can be controlled remotely or which radiate energy (excluding cellphones), will be classified as sensitive."

New IPC certification program to tackle intellectual property theft

To help combat the growing threat of intellectual property theft and counterfeiting, IPC—the association connecting electronics industries—recently launched a certification program that allows printed board manufacturers to demonstrate a commitment and ability to protect customers' intellectual property and comply with industry best practices.

"IPC's new Intellectual Property Protection Certification Program is designed to help improve facilities' programs and ultimately get them certified to a universally recognised standard," said Michael Moisan, vice president of global technology, TTM Technologies.

Analog Devices appoints Vincent Roche as CEO

Analog Devices has named Vincent Roche as president and CEO. He has also been elected to the board of directors.

Su-Kam Power Systems appoints new associate vice president

Su-Kam Power Systems has appointed Jatin Madan as the associate vice

president—global business development. He will be responsible for the company's businesses in overseas markets.

NEC India appoints new MD

NEC India has appointed Partho Dasgupta as the first managing director from India. He will undertake the leadership of NEC's business operations in the local market.

Bluetooth chip shipments to nearly double by 2017

The market for Bluetooth semiconductors is expected to nearly double by 2017, with the majority of the growth driven by demand for wireless combination integrated circuits (ICs) and mobile system-on-chip (MSoC) devices with integrated wireless connectivity that are used in mobile devices like smartphones and media tablets.

Worldwide shipments of ICs that include Bluetooth technology are set to rise to 3.1 billion units by 2017, up 91 per cent from 1.6 billion in 2011, according to a new report entitled 'Bluetooth—Classic or Smart Ready' from IMS Research, now part of IHS.

NFC device, secure element shipments to grow 120 per cent in 2013

NFC momentum continues to build despite the on-going delays affecting the launch of NFC payment services. Notable highlights of ABI Research's recent 'NFC Market Data' revealed that in 2012 shipments of secure elements were raised to 147 million with 125 million enabled handsets being shipped.

Growing inclusion of embedded solutions by OEMs will account for the majority of secure elements in 2013 as MNOs seed the market with close to 100 million SWP SIM cards.

Expected NFC-enabled device shipments were increased, and are forecast to reach a minimum of 320 million

units across all product categories by end 2013—an increase of 118 per cent over last year.

IFC, TERI to benchmark quality solar products

IFC, a member of the World Bank, is partnering with policy and research organisation, The Energy and Resources Institute (TERI), to upgrade the institute's solar lighting laboratory into a testing facility for ensuring quality solar lighting products for millions of Indians with no access to grid power.

Manufacturers will be able to get their products tested at the upgraded solar lighting laboratory of TERI University based on procedures specified by International Electrotechnical Commission, a body that sets all electrical standards worldwide. IEC testing will certify products for international quality assurance, helping manufacturers produce affordable-quality solar LED lights for end-users in India.

India proposes to fund almost 30 per cent solar construction costs

India is taking the solar scene pretty seriously. The country has offered to financially support almost a third of solar-plant construction costs, after it laid out the rules for the second phase of project auctions.

According to the draft guidelines published on the Ministry of New and Renewable Energy website, "The

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